

STAGE TWO • PROFESSIONAL IDENTITY & PERSONAL BRAND

FIRSTS

SESSION DEBRIEF / CLOSE-OUT SCRIPT

How to end each session, summarize, and bridge to what's next

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

BY AYOMIDE AYENI

FIRSTS • Session Debrief / Close-Out Script

Stage Two • Professional Identity & Personal Brand

WHY THIS MATTERS

A genuine close-out does three things every time: names what was actually accomplished, connects it forward to what's next, and gives a specific, concrete action to take before the next session. This matters more in a six-session stage than a three-session one — without a clear thread, forty individual FIRSTS can start to feel disconnected.

Close-Out Scripts

SESSION 1

Closing Session 1

"Today you built the foundation of how you present yourself: an introduction, a pitch, a brand statement, a communication style, a confidence commitment, and a value statement backed by a real outcome."

"Notice that everything after this point in the stage — your LinkedIn, your resume, your video introduction — should sound like the same person you just described today. Consistency is the whole game from here."

"Before next time: think about who you might ask for honest reputation feedback. We'll act on that at the start of Session 2."

SESSION 2

Closing Session 2

"Today moved from words to strategy: a brand strategy, a positioning statement, real reputation feedback, an honest image audit, credibility signals, and boundaries."

"The common thread today was intention. Reputation, image, and credibility all form whether or not you're paying attention — today was about paying attention on purpose."

"Before next time: make sure you have laptop access and your LinkedIn login ready. Next session is our most hands-on — we're building, not just planning."

SESSION 3

Closing Session 3

"That was a lot of real, tangible work: your LinkedIn profile, headline, and bio; a digital footprint audit; a personal website; a portfolio case study; and a real headshot."

"You now have a genuine online presence that didn't fully exist this morning. That's real progress, not just planning for progress."

"Before next time: bring your phone — we'll be recording ourselves speaking in the next session, building on the confidence work from Session 1."

SESSION 4

Closing Session 4

"Today was about live communication: email, meetings, questions, listening, and two rounds of seeing and hearing yourself on camera."

"If watching yourself back felt uncomfortable, that's a completely normal reaction, and also exactly the point — you caught something today that you couldn't have caught any other way."

"Before next time: think of one article or post that's genuinely interested you recently. We'll use it in Session 5."

SESSION 5

Closing Session 5

"Today was about visibility: engaging with others' content, sharing your own perspective, outlining original writing, tracking an industry trend, and preparing real conversation starters."

"Visibility isn't one-size-fits-all. Whatever level you landed on today, from one thoughtful comment to a full outlined blog post, that's a legitimate starting point, not a lesser one."

"Before next time: bring your current resume and one real job listing you're genuinely interested in. Our final session turns everything from this stage into finished, usable materials."

SESSION 6

Closing Session 6 (Stage Close)

"That's Stage Two, complete. Over six sessions, you've built a professional introduction and pitch, a brand strategy and positioning, a full digital presence, genuine communication skills, real visibility, and now finished materials — a tailored resume, a cover letter opener, contact materials, and a portfolio walkthrough."

"The capstone today, FIRST B40, was checking every platform against every other one. That habit — periodically cross-checking your whole presence — is one you should genuinely keep doing, not something that ends when this program does."

"Before we close: name one specific inconsistency you found today and actually fixed. Not something you plan to fix — something you already did."

"Stage Three picks up with Job Application & Interview Skills — everything we built here becomes the raw material for actually landing the opportunity."